Data Dictionary for CMS Fast Facts

Data Dictionary | Apr 2026 Release

TIBBLE	CMS Fast Facts	ROWS	657	COLUMNS	15

TABLE

OVERVIEW

The CMS Fast Facts includes summary information on total program enrollment, utilization, expenditures, as well as total number of Medicare providers, including physicians by specialty area.

This version of the CMS Fast Fact as a “standardized dataset”, unifying the data structure from the 10+ Excel files so all the data can live in the same dataset. This makes it easier for analyst to work with the data for analysis and visualization purposes. Another change here as well as is this file contains historic data from CMS Fast Facts releases since 2020, not just the most recent release.

The most recent release (PDF and Excel) as well as methodology can be found on Data.CMS.gov and the open source source code on GitHub

WHAT'S NEW IN 2026

```
- Medicare Populations, CY 2025
- Medicaid & CHIP Populations, CY 2025
- Medicare Deductibles, Coinsurance, Premiums, CY 2026
- Original Medicare Persons Served and Payments by Type of Service, CY 2024
- Medicare Part D Utilization and Expenditures, CY 2024
- Medicaid & CHIP Payments by Type of Service, FY 2024
- Medicare Institutional Providers, CY 2024
- Medicare Non-Institutional Providers by Specialty, CY 2024
- Medicare Durable Medical Equipment Prosthetics, Orthotics & Supplies (DMEPOS) Providers by Spec
- Medicare Prepaid Contracts, February 2026
- National Health Expenditures, CY 2024
- CMS Financial Data, FY 2025
```

COLUMNS

`area` character

INFO Various “programatic” buckets the data are sorted into.
Levels (5): CMS | Federal | Medicaid & CHIP | Medicare | National

`topic` character

INFO Key topical segments of the reported CMS data.
Levels (8): Cost Sharing | Enrollment | Expenditures | Financial | NHE | Providers | Staffing | Utilization

`category` character

INFO Each topic is disaggregated into a number of different categories
Levels (51): FTE Employment | Psychiatry | Rural Health Clinics | Fraud | Orthopedic Surgery | Medical Specialties | Ambulance Service Supplier | Labs, ...

`sub_category` character

INFO Finer disaggregations of `category`
Levels (61): Expansion Adult | Initial Coverage Limit | Total Health Care Fraud & Abuse Control Funding | Disabled | Inpatient Services | Children | Adults | Maximum Deductible, ...

`provider_type` character

INFO For providers only, specifies their “type”
Levels (3): DMEPOS | Institutional | Non-Institutional

`metric` character

INFO Specifies what is being measured in `value`
Levels (13): persons_served | enrollment | premium | count | deductible | expenditure | expenditures | coinsurance, ...

`period_type` character

INFO Specifies whether the reporting `year` is a calendar year (CY) or fiscal year (FY)
Levels (2): CY | FY

`data_year` integer

INFO The associated year for the reported `value`. Due to reporting lags, the `data_year` may be one or more years prior to the CMS Fast Factsrelease_date. Each `topic` in a given release may cover one or more years.

Levels: 2018-2026

`value` numeric

INFO The value associated with the reported `metric`. Values have been adjusted from the CMS Fast Facts Excel file into their correct units. For example, for the financial data (`topic == 'Financial'`), the data are reported in millions of USD. In the Excel file, the CHIP value is `19,457`; in this dataset, that number has been converted to the correct units, `19,457,000,000` CALC

`bound` character

INFO Relevant for only Part B Premiums (`topic == "Cost Sharing"`): specifies whether the value is the upper or lower bound of the range
Levels (2): lower | upper

`source` character

INFO Identifies the CMS Fast Facts Excel file where the data was sourced from. When there were multiple releases within a given year, the lastest release from that year was used.

`source_tab` character

INFO Identifies specific sheet from the CMS Fast Facts Excel file where the data was sourced from.
Levels (10): CMS Financial Data | NHE | Medicare Utilization | Institutional Providers | DMEPOS Providers | Populations | Medicare Part D | Medicaid & CHIP Expenditures, ...

`source_origin` character

INFO Identifies where the data originated from within CMS.
Levels (7): CMS/Center for Medicaid and CHIP Services | CMS/Office of Enterprise Data & Analytics | CMS/Office of Enterprise Data & Analytics/Centers for Medicaid and CHIP Services | CMS/Office of Enterprise Data & Analytics/Office of the Actuary | CMS/Office of Financial Management | CMS/Office of the Actuary | https://www.medicare.gov

`release_date` Date

INFO The month and year of the release (a data sorted in ISO format, `YYYY–MM–DD`), extracted from the CMS Fast Facts Excel file name.

`is_latest` logical

INFO Boolean that specifies if the reported value is from the latest reported year as this might be different across each `metric`.

METHODOLOGY

CREATION

Dataset generated 2026-04-27

SOURCE REFERENCE INFORMATION & METHODOLOGY (APR 2026 RELEASE)

Populations

Medicare Enrollment

The data reported in the Medicare Populations table come from CMS administrative enrollment data for beneficiaries enrolled in the Medicare program. The data are sourced from the CMS Chronic Conditions Data Warehouse (CCW), a database with 100% of Medicare enrollment and claims data.

The Medicare enrollment counts are determined using a person-year methodology. For each calendar year, total person-year counts are determined by summing the total number of months that each beneficiary is enrolled in Parts A and/or B during the year and dividing by 12. Using this methodology, a beneficiary's partial-year enrollment may be counted in more than 1 category (i.e., entitlement type and health care delivery), where appropriate.

Medicaid & CHIP Enrollment

The Medicaid and Children's Health Insurance Program (CHIP) enrollment counts come from the Medicaid & CHIP Scorecard. - The total and children counts are sourced from the State Medicaid and CHIP Applications Eligibility Determinations, and Enrollment Data. - The dual-eligible enrollment count are sourced from the MMCO Statistical & Analytic Reports: Enrollment Snapshots of dual-eligible beneficiaries. - The adult expansion count are sourced from the Medicaid Budget and Expenditure System's Medicaid Enrollment – New Adult Group data.

Medicare Deductibles, Coinsurance & Premiums

The Medicare deductible, coinsurance and premiums information reported in this table are sourced from the following: - [Medicare Part A and Part B Costs])(https://www.medicare.gov/basics/costs/medicare-costs) - Medicare Part D Costs

Medicare Utilization and Payments by Type of Service

The counts and amounts in the table and charts are sourced from CMS administrative enrollment and claims data for fee-for-service beneficiaries enrolled in Medicare, available from the CCW database.

Medicare Part D Utilization and Expenditures

The utilization data (Utilizing Beneficiaries and Prescription Drug Events) for this table come from CMS administrative enrollment data for beneficiaries enrolled in the Medicare Part D program, available from the CCW database. The Part D expenditures data presented in the table are sourced from the Medicare Trustees Report.

Medicaid & CHIP Payments by Selected Type of Service

The data presented in the table and chart come from the Medicaid & CHIP Scorecard. The Scorecard is sourced from the Medicaid Budget and Expenditure System/State Children's Health Insurance Program Budget and Expenditure System (MBES/CBES).

Medicare Institutional Providers

The counts reported in this table are sourced from the Provider of Services (POS). The POS data contain characteristics of institutional providers, such as hospitals and other types of healthcare facilities.

Medicare Non-Institutional Providers by Specialty

The counts reported in this table come from Medicare fee-for-service Part B claims data, available from the CCW database, and represent professionals providing services to Original Medicare beneficiaries for all Part B non-institutional services (excluding DMEPOS services).

Medicare Durable Medical Equipment, Prosthetics, Orthotics and Supplies (DMPOS) Providers by Specialty

The counts reported in this table come from Medicare fee-for-service Part B claims data, available from the CCW database, and represent DMEPOS professionals providing services to Original Medicare beneficiaries for DMEPOS services.

Medicare Prepaid Contracts

The data for this table are sourced from the latest available Monthly Contract and Enrollment Summary Report.

National Health Expenditures

The data for this table are sourced from the National Health Expenditure Accounts (NHEA), which are the official estimates of total health care spending in the United States.

CMS Financial Data

The data for this table are sourced from the Budget Appendix of the President's Budget of the United States Government, prepared by the Office of Management and Budget.